

Apple MacBook Air M4

Still the Best Thin-n-Light Laptop?

Apple's MacBook Air lineup has always stood as a benchmark for ultra-thin, ultra-portable laptops. With the introduction of the new 13-inch MacBook Air M4 in 2025, Apple doubles down on its winning formula, but with a few thoughtful tweaks that make it even more compelling. At ₹99,900 for the 16GB RAM + 256GB storage variant, it offers a surprisingly well-rounded package that's quieter, cooler (literally and aesthetically), and more capable than ever before.

After spending several weeks using the M4 MacBook Air as my daily driver for everything from writing and photo editing to gaming and video rendering, I have a lot to say about its strengths, weaknesses, and everything in between.

DESIGN, BUILD QUALITY, KEYBOARD & TOUCHPAD

On the outside, not much has changed from the M2 and M3 designs, and that's a good thing. The 13-inch M4 MacBook Air continues to be one of the sleekest and lightest premium laptops on the market. Its all-aluminium chassis feels reassuringly sturdy, with no flex on the keyboard deck or lid, and its footprint makes it easy to slide into any bag without adding noticeable bulk. It's 11.3mm thin and weighs just 1.24kg, a delight for anyone who's always on the move.

But what sets it apart this year is the new Sky Blue colour, which adds just enough flair to the minimalist design language. Under sunlight, it glows with a rich blue hue, but in indoor lighting or shadow, it subtly transitions to silver, creating a sophisticated dual-tone



effect. People in the office couldn't stop complimenting it, as it's easily one of the most aesthetically pleasing laptops Apple has made in years.

The keyboard retains Apple's now-mature scissor-switch mechanism.

It's comfortable for long typing sessions, responsive, and just the right amount of clicky without being noisy. Below it, the large Force Touch trackpad continues to be industry-leading in terms of gesture responsiveness and palm rejection. Even after hours of usage, it remains precise, and the surface feels smooth to the touch.

DISPLAY AND SPEAKERS

The 13.6-inch Liquid Retina display may still be locked at 60Hz, but it's a good one. With a resolution of 2560×1664 and support for P3 wide colour and True Tone, it renders crisp text, vibrant images, and punchy video. Brightness peaks at 500 nits, which is more than adequate for indoor use and tolerable outdoors, unless you're sitting under direct sun.

Apple hasn't made the jump to ProMotion on the Air, so you won't get 120Hz smoothness like on the MacBook Pro, but for most users—browsing,

writing, watching videos, editing photos—the panel performs beautifully. It's colour-accurate enough for most design and photography work, and the pixel density makes reading a joy.

The four-speaker system is surprisingly punchy for a laptop this slim. Positioned under the display and bouncing sound off the surface, it delivers clean mids and highs. Bass is present, though not room-shaking. For video calls, Netflix binges, YouTube sessions, or even music playback in a small room, the setup is more than capable. If you want six speakers, you'll need to step up to the 15-inch Air or the MacBook Pro.

WEBCAM AND MIC QUALITY

The webcam has received a noticeable bump this year. It's now a 12MP sensor and supports Apple's Centre Stage feature, which intelligently keeps you in frame during video calls. Whether you're on Zoom, Google Meet, or FaceTime, the image quality is sharp, colours are well balanced, and Centre Stage works reliably. The built-in mic array also captures voice clearly with decent noise isolation, making it a great all-in-one machine for remote workers or students.

PERFORMANCE: BURSTY, EFFICIENT, AND SURPRISINGLY STRONG

The MacBook Air M4 is powered by Apple's new M4 chip, which is based on a 3nm architecture. It features a mix of performance and efficiency cores that enable snappy responsiveness in regular use, along with surprisingly robust output in creative workloads.

There's no fan. Zero. And yet the MacBook Air remains remarkably cool during normal tasks and only gets warm under load. Apple's thermal management here is excellent, and the fact that you get this level of performance in complete silence is genuinely impressive.

In tasks like writing, emailing, multitasking with productivity apps, or managing a dozen browser tabs, the M4 chip simply flies. Everything feels